

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 424

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor The Knoxville Barristers,
2025 Business Award recipient of the John J.
Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary organization of concerned citizens is The Knoxville Barristers, which was recently named the 2025 Business Award recipient of the John J. Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy; and

WHEREAS, the John J. Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy was created to honor those who steadfastly work to improve the lives of seniors in the Knoxville community, as the award's namesake did throughout his career; recipients are professionals, community members, and business owners who have been nominated in recognition of their tireless efforts on behalf of seniors; and

WHEREAS, The Knoxville Barristers is the Young Lawyers Division of the Knoxville Bar Association, comprised primarily of attorneys under the age of thirty-six or in their first five years of practice; however, participation in the Barristers' public service projects is open to legal professionals of all ages and roles, including lawyers, paralegals, legal assistants, and even judges; and

WHEREAS, the members of The Knoxville Barristers have demonstrated over twenty-five years of unwavering dedication to serving homebound seniors in Knox County through its partnership with CAC Mobile Meals; and

WHEREAS, in the late 1990s, The Barristers became involved with Mobile Meals when then President Saja Hoffpauir and other members formed the organization's Hunger and Poverty Relief Committee and took on the role of coordinating the Barristers' various community service efforts; and

WHEREAS, one of the very first projects coordinated by the Hunger and Poverty Relief Committee was providing volunteers once a month to deliver Mobile Meals to homebound seniors in Knox County; and

WHEREAS, over time, the Mobile Meals project became increasingly popular among The Barristers' membership and expanded to also include older members of the Knoxville bar; attorneys from every practice area and firms of every size began participating, along with paralegals and even several judges; and

WHEREAS, since its inception, the project has grown from the original once-a-month undertaking to an expanded three or four days per week schedule, with the current partnership led by Nic Arning of Wolf, McClane, Bright, Allen, & Carpenter, PLLC; and

WHEREAS, The Barristers members have delivered meals approximately 3,000 times, completing an astounding 40,000 individual deliveries; by serving the same route each time, volunteers have built meaningful relationships with the seniors they serve, providing not only nutritional support but also vital safety checks and social connection; and

WHEREAS, The Knoxville Barristers' twenty-five years of impactful volunteerism goes beyond the delivery of meals, as it represents a steadfast commitment to the well-being and dignity of Knox County's aging population; the Barristers' dedication to Mobile Meals sets an exceptional example of partnership and volunteerism, and the division's leadership inspires others in the community and underscores the importance of sustained, compassionate action to address the needs of older adults; and

WHEREAS, the members of The Knoxville Barristers have worked tirelessly to improve their community, and it is most fitting that they be honored on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor The Knoxville Barristers, the Young Lawyers Division of the Knoxville Bar Association, the 2025 Business Award recipient of the John J. Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy, extending our best wishes for continued success in all further endeavors to compassionately and devotedly serve others.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.